



iPhone on prepaid?

Cricket Wireless is now offering a \$55 monthly prepaid plan for the iPhone 4S. <http://dgit.in/KeAIDW>



Max Payne on Android

Max Payne, Rockstar's most award winning game is now available on Google Play store for ₹166. <http://dgit.in/KVWDzu>

only of relevance if you like to keep fiddling with and resetting your router.

PERFORMANCE

The internal antennas on the ASUS RT-N15U did impact the performance of the device. The hit in performance wasn't too bad, but enough to make the ₹6,000 price tag unjustified, especially when you consider the stellar performance of the TP-Link WR-841N, which had literally double the performance of the other routers in our test. At ₹2,000, this is real value for money. In fact, the performance of the TP-Link WR-841N was way better than most of the routers in our tests, dual-band included. Only the ASUS RT-N66U, at six times the price, managed similar performance. In fact, the performance of all the TP-Link routers was exceptional in all our tests, so much so that we can quite safely say that if you want a single-band router, get one from TP-Link (not considering aesthetics of course).

Winners

The **Best Buy** award here goes to the **TP-Link TL-WR740N**, a cheap, no-frills router, this one performed admirably in our tests, especially considering that it was also the cheapest router in our test. The build



TP-Link TL-WR740N



Netgear WNDR3700

may not be as good as some of the ASUS routers, but the performance and price more than justify the award. The **Best Performer** award again goes to a TP-Link router, this time it was the **TP-Link WR-841N**. Why the award? The performance of this router was simply stellar in this category and none of the other devices even came close. The tables speak for themselves. Dual-band performance at ₹2,000? Why not?

DUAL-BAND ROUTERS

This category had only eight devices, three of which were from ASUS, the rest from D-LINK, Netgear, SMC and Belkin. TP-Link did not have any router in this category, and considering their performance, we were a bit disappointed to not see their devices here.

FEATURES AND SPECIFICATIONS

These routers were the most expensive in our tests, ranging in price from ₹6,000 to ₹13,500. Interestingly, only the ASUS RT-N66U and SMC SMCWGBR14-N2 had external antennas, the rest going with internal antennas. USB ports were also prevalent, with only the ASUS RT-N53 without one.

Interestingly, the D-Link DIR-827 was the only router in the test with an SD card slot as well as a USB 3.0 port. One thing to note here is that while USB 3.0 might seem to be a good thing on a router, if you are only going to stream data wirelessly, it is on no consequence and there is no point paying extra for it. Wired connections will obviously benefit from the increased throughput of USB 3.0. One shocking item in these tests was the warranty on the SMC router, only 3 months where almost everyone else was providing at least a 3 year.



D-Link DIR-636L

The D-Link DIR-827 also had only a 1 year warranty for whatever reason. Another important point to note is that only the ASUS RT-N53 and N66U had support for DD-WRT, which is a huge bonus for those who want to tinker around with their systems.



ASUS RT-N66U



TP-Link TL-WR841N

PERFORMANCE

In terms of pure performance the SMC SMCWGBR14-N2 and Belkin N750DB proved themselves quite capable at close range, they however lost out badly when it came to range and signal strength. The ASUS routers, especially the RT-N66U, and the D-Link 636L had the best signal strength in the tests and managed to provide a stable connection upto zone 3.

Winners

The **Best Buy** award in this category goes to the **D-Link DIR-636L**. The performance was quite good at the price and despite the 300 Mbps cap (compared to the 900 Mbps behemoths), the performance was very good, plus, the unique tubular design might appeal to some!

The **Best Performer** award is only given to one device in the test, so the ASUS RT-N66U had to be left out, but if you want a dual-band router, performance no-bar, this is one to go for. A cheaper alternative would be the SMC-WGBR14-N2, if you don't need the range.

The **Editor's Pick** goes to the **Netgear WNDR3700**. This unassuming router did not feature anywhere prominently in our tests, but is, in fact, second only to the ASUS RT-N66U and quite a good deal at the price. **d**